

Markelo — Capture Sheet and Synthesis Method

Why this document exists: Many people will do interviews in different places. If everyone writes notes in their own format, we get anecdotes instead of evidence. Everyone must use the same capture sheet. This makes the results comparable.

Part 1 — Interview capture sheet

Copy this block for every single interview. Fill it within one hour of the conversation.

INTERVIEW RECORD

Interview ID: MK-INT-____

Date:

Interviewer name:

Location (institution, department):

Institution type: ☐ Federal ☐ State ☐ Private ☐ Polytechnic ☐ College of Education

PARTICIPANT

Role/title:

Years in role:

Consent form signed: ☐ Yes ☐ No

Video consent given: ☐ Yes ☐ No

Publication consent: ☐ Yes ☐ No

SCALE (numbers only – no estimates unless marked)

Students in largest class:

Scripts handled per exam period:

Number of staff who mark:

Time from exam to result release:

[Mark any number you estimated with "~"]

CURRENT PROCESS

Describe the steps they told you, in their order. Do not correct or tidy it.

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

ARTIFACTS SEEN

☐ Control sheet / cover page ☐ Mark sheet ☐ Scanner (make/model: _____)

☐ Result portal ☐ CA score file ☐ Other: _____

Photos taken: ☐ Yes ☐ No File names:

DIRECT QUOTES (their exact words – no paraphrasing)

"
"
"

PROBLEMS THEY RAISED THEMSELVES (unprompted – these are the strongest signal)

- 1.
- 2.

ASSUMPTIONS TESTED (see 01-assumption-map.md)

ID | Supported | Contradicted | Still unknown | Evidence

A1		☐		☐		☐	
A2		☐		☐		☐	
A3		☐		☐		☐	
A4		☐		☐		☐	
A5		☐		☐		☐	
A6		☐		☐		☐	
A11		☐		☐		☐	

SURPRISES

What did you hear that you did not expect?

INTERVIEWER CONFIDENCE

- ☐ High – they were open and specific
- ☐ Medium – some answers were vague
- ☐ Low – rushed, or they told me what I wanted to hear

FOLLOW-UP

Contact given: ☐ Yes ☐ No

Referred us to:

Next action:

Part 2 – Current-state observation checklist

Use this when you can watch the process or see the room. **Observation beats interview.** People describe their own process inaccurately. Paper does not.

Physical script journey – record what you see

- Where are blank booklets stored before the exam?
- Who carries scripts from the exam hall? In what container?
- Where do scripts sit between collection and marking? Is it locked?
- How are scripts counted? Is there a signed handover record?
- How are scripts grouped – by course, by hall, by department?

Photograph these if permitted

1. A blank answer booklet, front and back
2. Any existing cover sheet or attendance sheet
3. A completed mark sheet
4. The scanner or photocopier, including the model label
5. The result portal upload screen
6. The room where scripts are stored

Count these

- Pages in a typical booklet
- Booklets in a typical bundle
- Staff involved from collection to result

Ask about the exception, not the normal case

- What happens when a student uses a second booklet?
 - What happens when a script has no name on it?
 - What happens when a script is found after results are released?
 - What happens when a marker becomes unavailable halfway through?
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Part 3 — Weekly synthesis method

Do this every week during the campaign. Do not wait until the end.

Step 1 — Collect. Put all capture sheets in one place.

Step 2 — Count the assumption results. For each assumption ID, count Supported / Contradicted / Still unknown.

Step 3 — Apply the evidence rule.

- **1 source** = a signal. Write it down. Change nothing.
- **3 or more independent sources that agree** = evidence. You may change the design.
- **Any contradiction** = stop and investigate. A single strong contradiction is more valuable than five weak confirmations.

Step 4 — Update the assumption map. Move rows between tiers. Record the date and the evidence.

Step 5 — Write the weekly summary. Three items only:

1. What we learned that we did not know last week.
2. What this changes in the product.
3. What we still cannot answer.

Step 6 — Report the numbers honestly. Say "4 of 7 exam officers said X". Never say "exam officers say X" when you spoke to four people.

Common mistakes to avoid

Mistake	Why it damages the research
Describing Markelo before asking questions	The person agrees to be polite. The answer becomes worthless.
Asking "would you use this?"	People say yes and never buy. Ask what they do now instead.
Only interviewing friendly contacts	Friendly people agree with you. Find people who will say no.
Writing notes days later	You will remember your conclusion, not their words.
Counting one enthusiastic person as proof	One person is a signal, not evidence.
Skipping the ICT director	This person can block the sale.